

element's child `<visible>` property is commented out by default. Because this value defaults to false, if the window construction code never succeeds to a runtime error, you're left with an invisible window and ADL still in memory. To solve this, open the application's descriptor file, uncomment the `<visible>` element, and set its value to true:

- `<visible>true</visible>`

Working with HTML-based content

The Flex framework offers two ways of creating a Web browser object within any application. One way is by the `HTMLLoader` class which is extended from the `Sprite` class and can be used in any Flash or Flex application. Because this class doesn't extend from `UIComponent`, you can't add it to a Flex container with simple MXML code or by using the `addChild()` or `addElement()` methods. The second way is through HTML control bring extended from `UIComponent` and can be instantiated with either MXML or ActionScript code.

The HTML control is quite a bit easier to use and provides the same functionality as `HTMLLoader`. Declaring an instance of the control results in a Web browser instance that can freely navigate to any location on the Web (assuming the client system is currently connected).

As with all visual controls, the HTML control can be instantiated in MXML or ActionScript code. After it's been instantiated, its location property determines which Web page is displayed. This HTML object, for example, displays Adobe's home page and expands to fill all available space within the application:

- `<mx:HTML id="myHTML" width="100%" height="100%"`
- `location="http://www.adobe.com"/>`

When you assign the HTML control's `id` property, you can then reset its location as needed from any ActionScript code. In addition to the location property, the HTML control implements these methods that enable you to control navigation with ActionScript code:

- `historyBack()` - Navigates back one step in the control's history list.
- `historyForward()` - Navigates back one step in the control's history list.
- `historyGo(steps:int)` - Navigates the number of steps. The value of the `steps` argument can be positive to move forward or negative to move back.

Using the WindowedApplication component

Flex applications designed for desktop deployment typically use